

REFERRAL LETTER

Date: 02/01/2026 (fake)

Re: Patient John Synthetic-Roe, DOB 05/05/1975 (fake)

Patient is referred for lumbar spine MRI due to persistent low back pain radiating to the right leg, ongoing for 10 weeks.

PHYSICIAN EXAM NOTE

Neurological exam:

Motor strength is 3/5 in the right lower extremity, consistent with L5 radiculopathy.

Sensory exam shows decreased sensation to light touch in the right L5 dermatome (dorsum of the right foot).

Right ankle reflex is absent compared to a normal left ankle reflex, an asymmetric finding.

Patient denies any bowel or bladder incontinence or retention.

Patient denies fever, unexplained weight loss, recent trauma, or history of cancer.

MEDICATION AND IMAGING HISTORY

Conservative treatment: naproxen 500mg BID for 7 weeks, and methocarbamol for muscle spasm.

Symptom duration is 10 weeks, per patient report and referral letter.

Lumbar spine X-ray performed on 12/20/2025 showed mild degenerative disc changes at L4-L5, no fracture.

PHYSICAL THERAPY NOTES

Physical therapy: 10 sessions completed over 7 weeks, minimal improvement in pain or function.